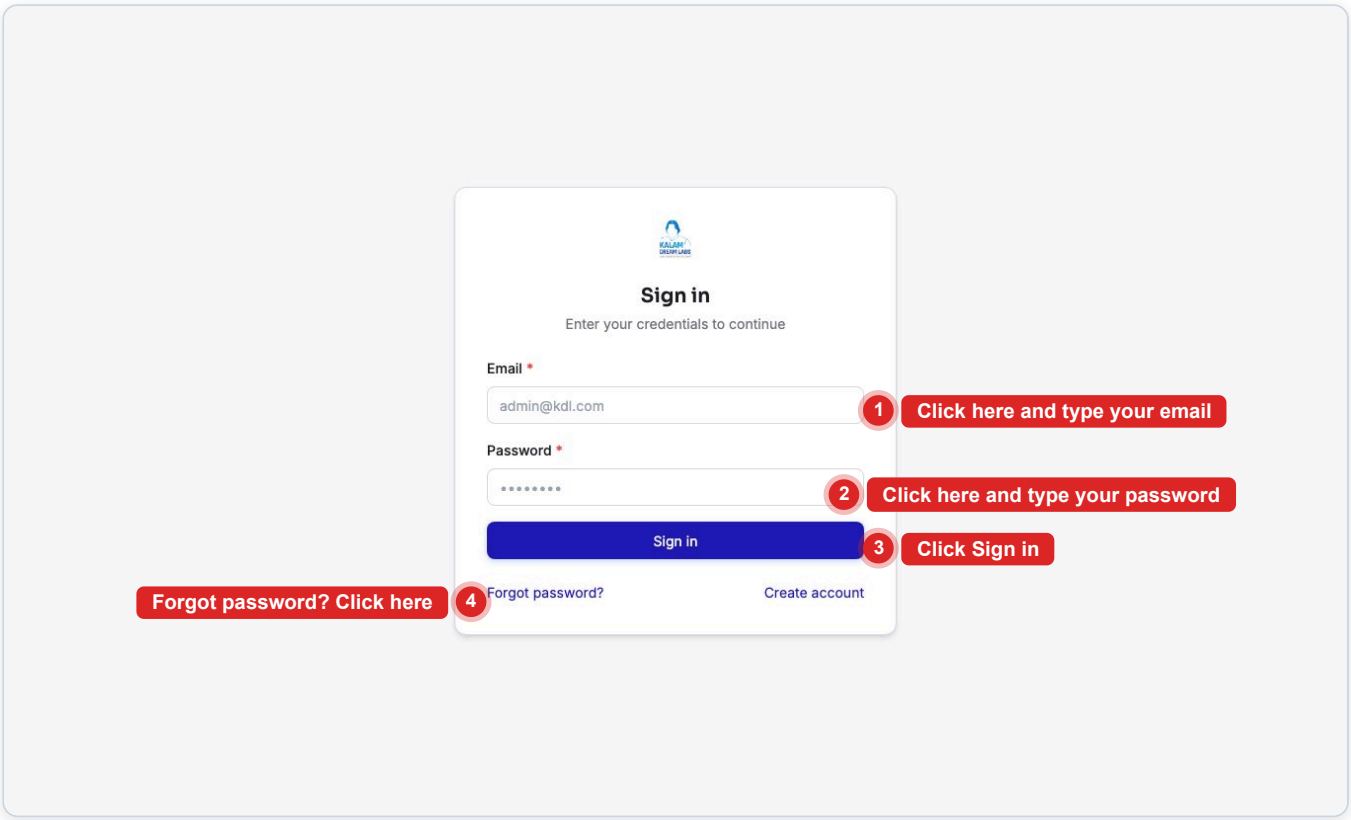
Step 1. Sign in

> KDL OS must already be installed and running. If not, follow the **Installation** guide first (Admin > Documents > Installation).

Open **http://localhost/login**. Email `admin@kdl.com`, password `kdl-dev-seed-password`. KDL OS asks you to choose a new password on first sign-in.

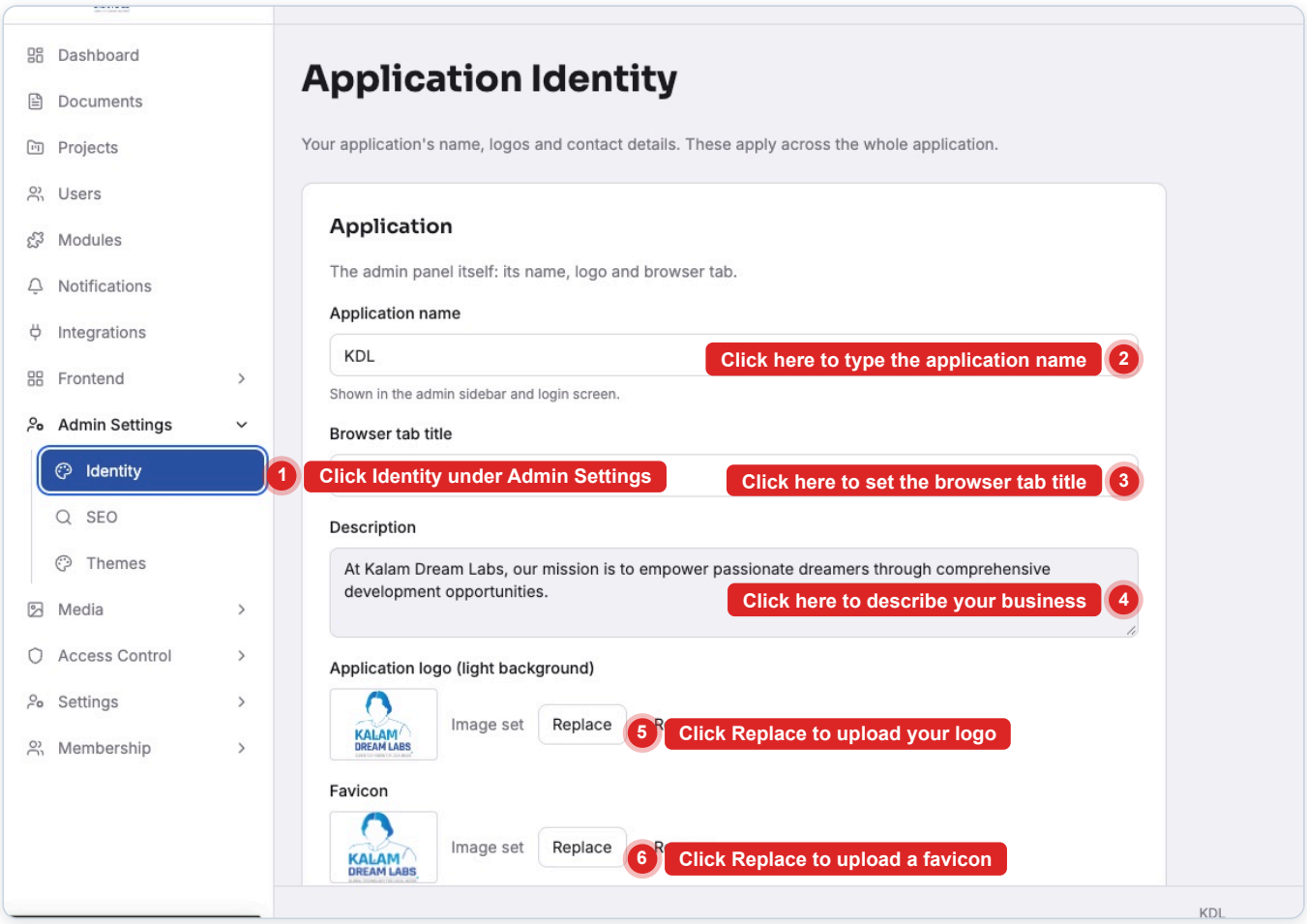


The sign-in screen

> Forgot the password or locked out? `docker compose exec backend node scripts/reset-admin-password.js --email admin@kdl.com --password 'Admin@123'` (at least 8 characters), then sign in with it. 429 or "Account locked" while testing: wait a minute or `docker compose restart backend`.

Step 2. Open Application Identity

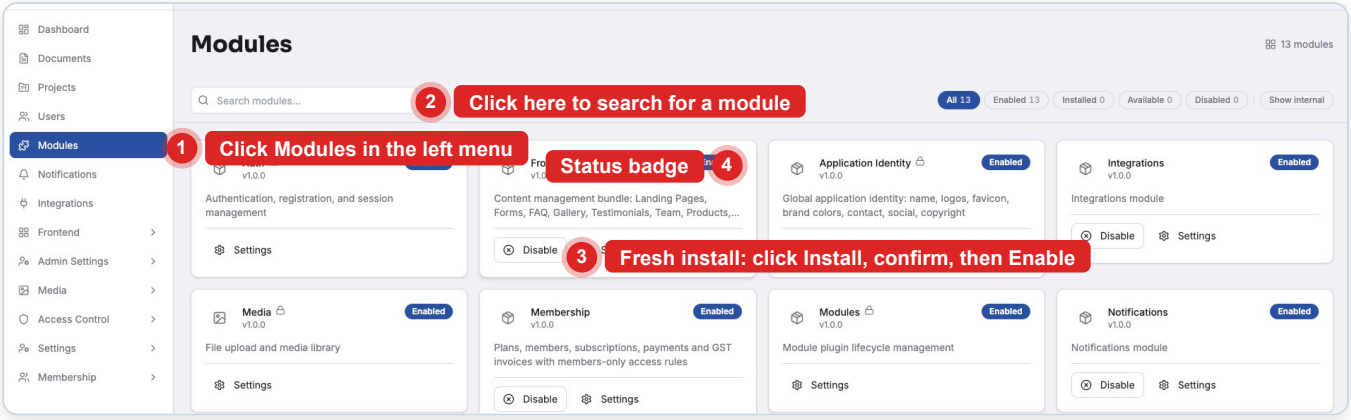
After you sign in, open **Admin Settings > Identity** in the left menu. This is where the application name, logo and favicon are set.



Admin Settings > Identity

Step 3. Open Modules, install and enable Frontend

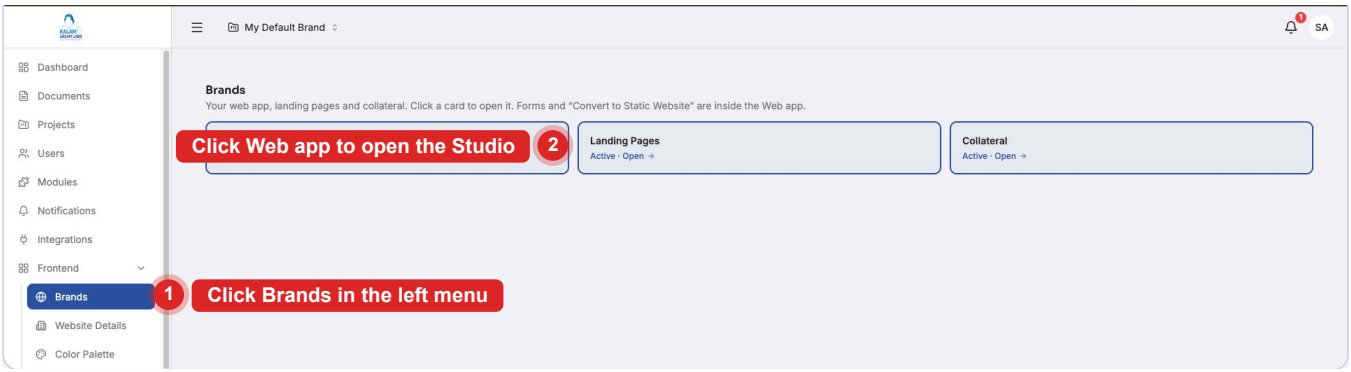
Click **Modules** in the left menu. Find the **Frontend** card (use the search box if you need to). On a fresh install the card shows **Install**: click it and confirm, then click **Enable** and confirm. The badge changes to **Enabled**.



Modules: the Frontend card

Step 4. Open the Studio

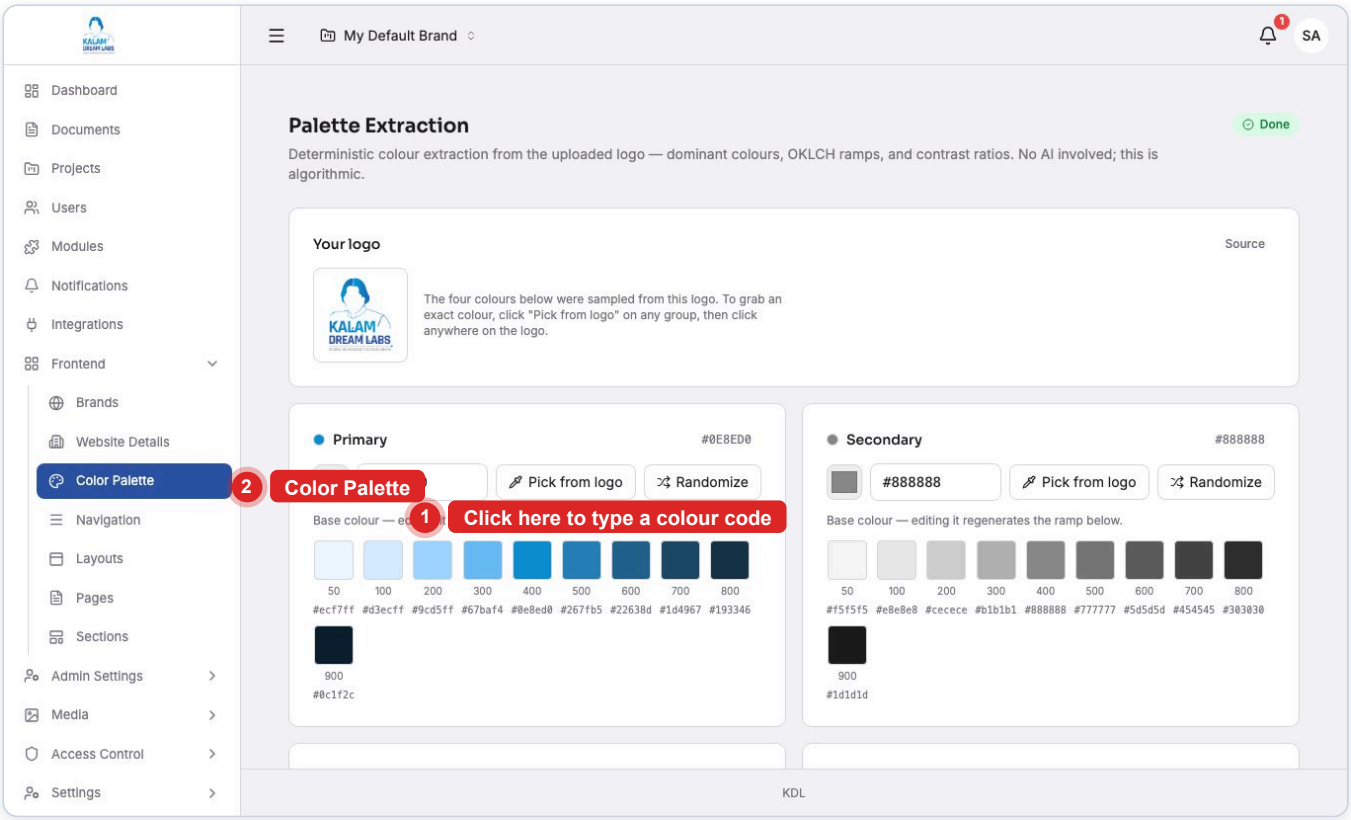
Click **Frontend > Brands** in the left menu, then click the **Web app** card. This opens the Studio for your website. The first time, click **Start Studio run**. Tabs along the top: Overview, Color Palette and Website.



Brands: open the Web app

Step 5. Color Palette

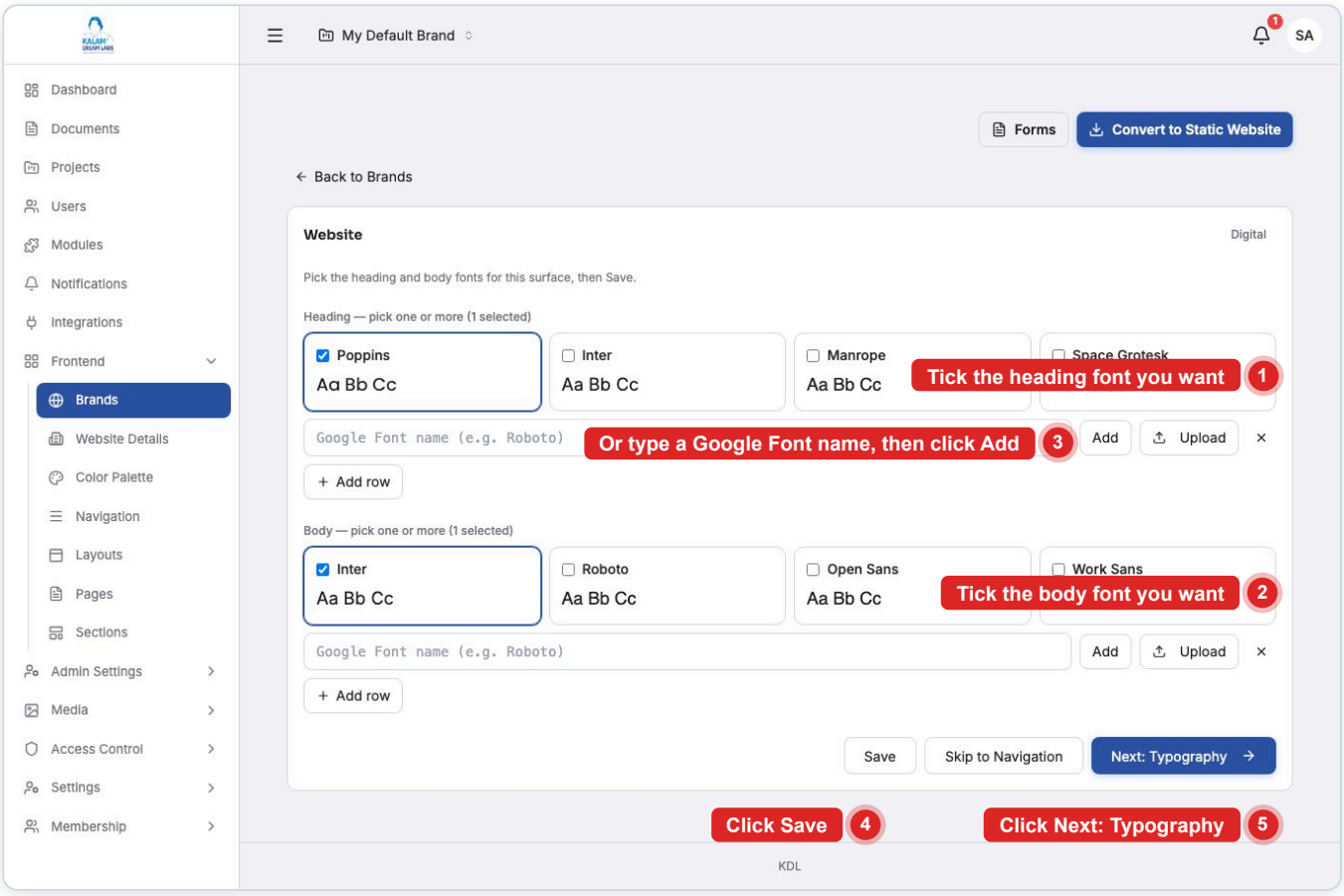
Four brand colours are taken from your logo: Primary, Secondary, Tertiary and Quaternary. Keep them, or click a colour box and type a new code, click **Pick from logo** or **Randomize**. Then click **Submit palette**. The colours become the website's design tokens.



Studio: Color Palette

Step 6. Typography: choose the fonts

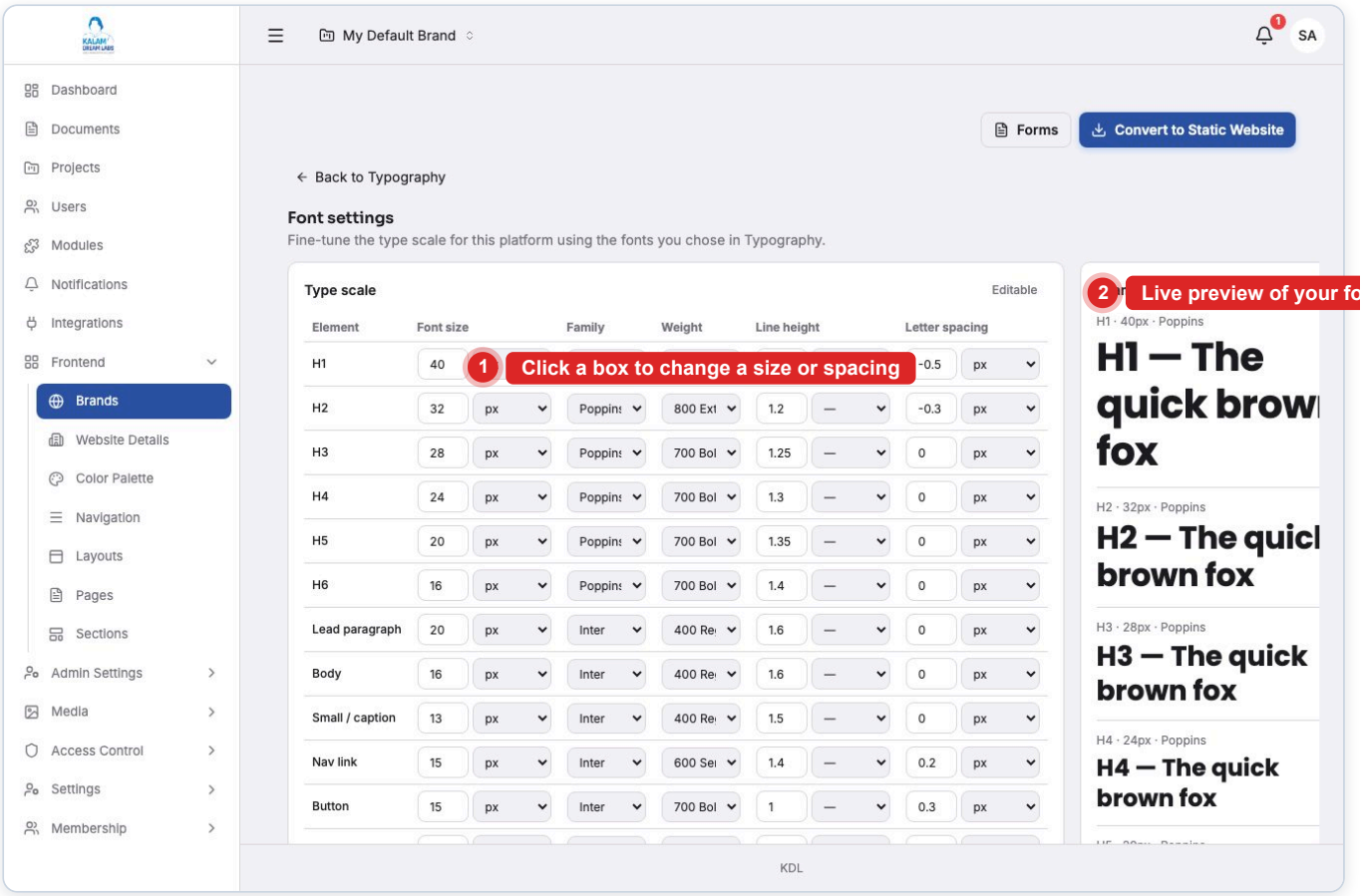
The Website stage opens on **Typography**. Under **Heading** tick the font for titles, and under **Body** tick the font for normal text. To use another font, type its Google Font name (for example Roboto) and click **Add**, or click **Upload** to add your own font file. Click **Save**, then click **Next: Typography** to continue.



Website stage: Typography

Step 7. Font settings

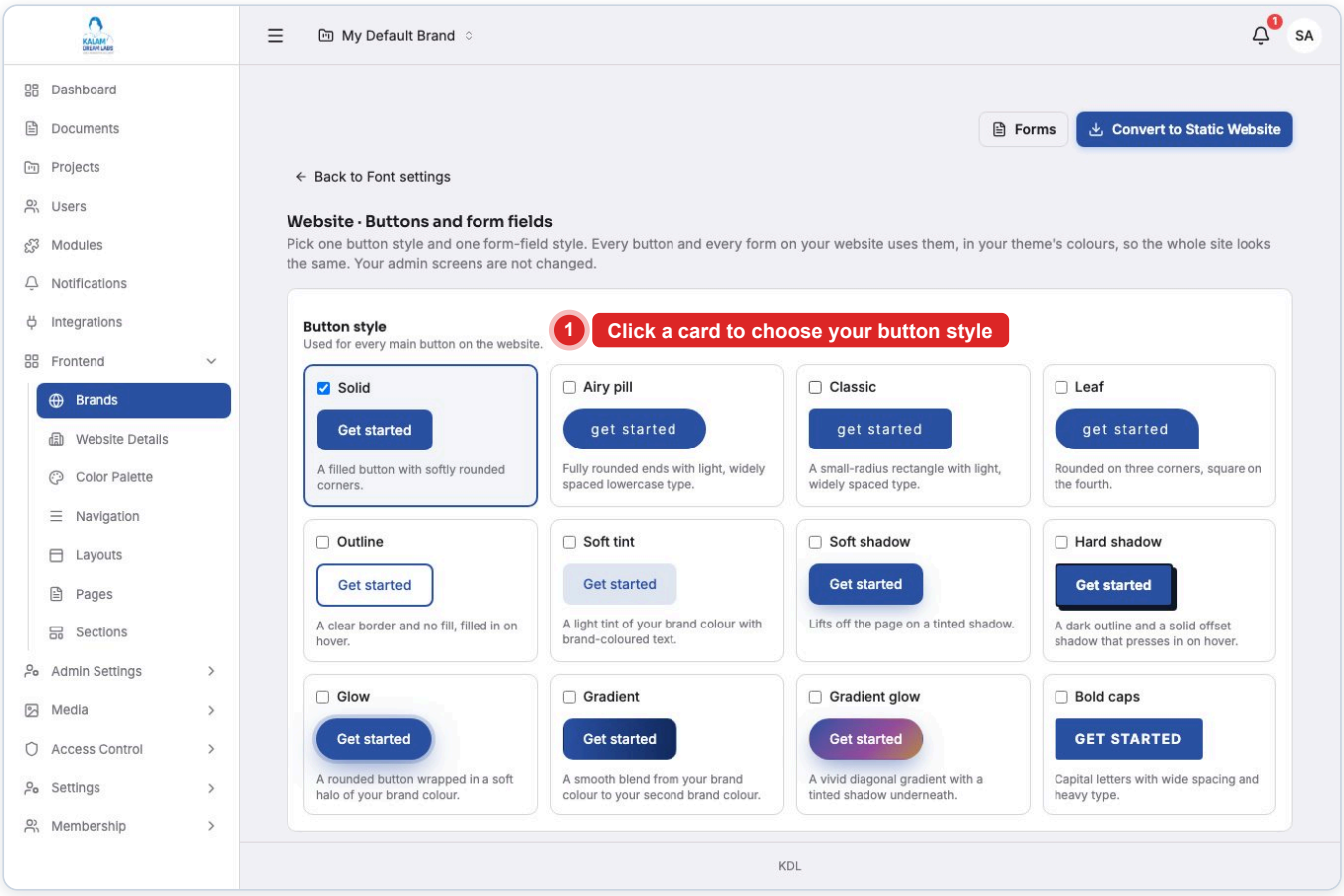
Fine-tune the type scale: for each element (H1 to H6, Lead paragraph, Body, Small, Nav link, Button) change the font size, family, weight, line height and letter spacing. The **Examples** panel on the right shows the result live. The defaults are a good start. Scroll down and click **Next: Buttons and form fields**.



Website stage: Font settings

Step 8. Buttons and form fields

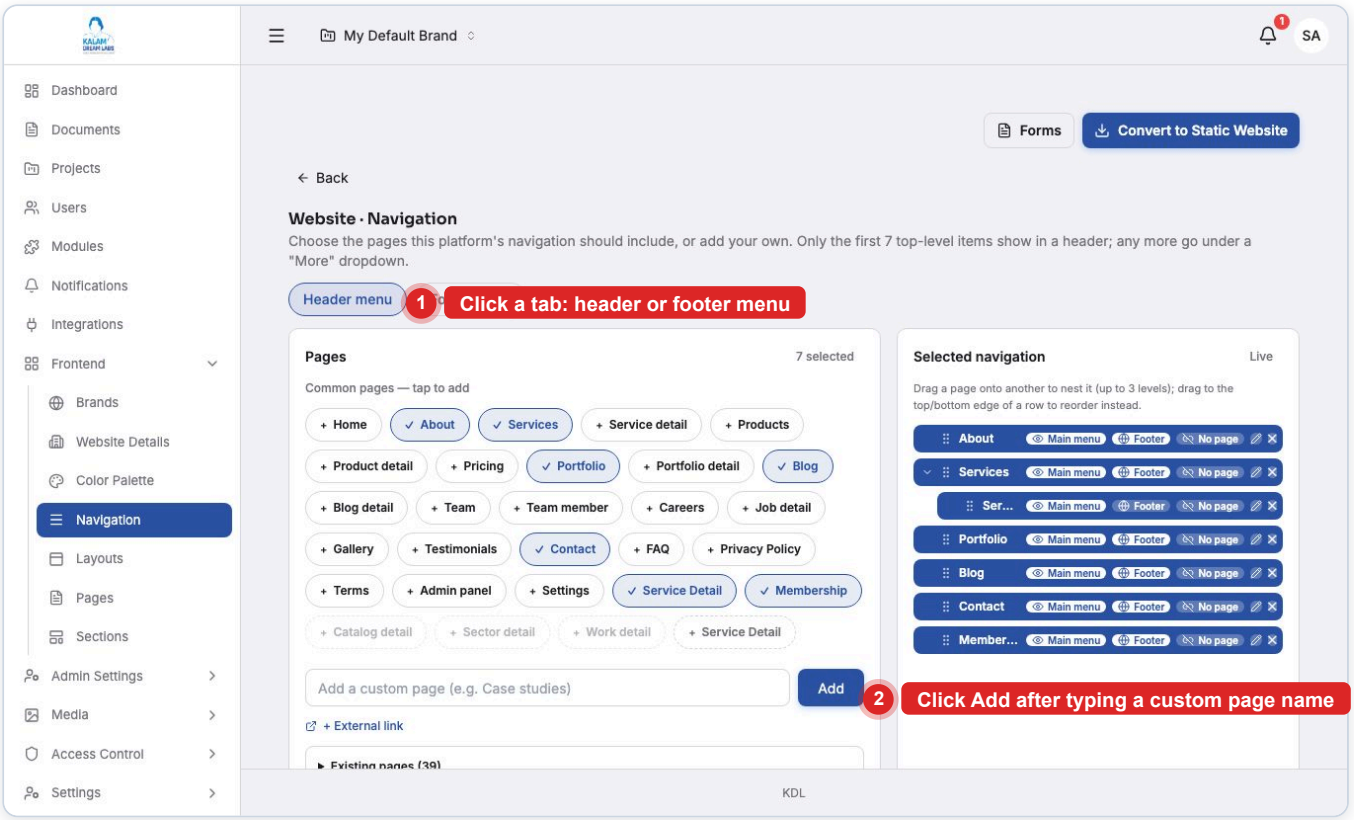
Click one card under **Button style** (Solid, Airy pill, Classic, Leaf, Outline, Soft tint and more), then scroll down and click one card under **Form field style**. Every button and every form on your website uses them, in your theme's colours. The admin screens are not changed. Click **Next** to continue to Navigation.



Website stage: Button style

Step 9. Choose the menu pages

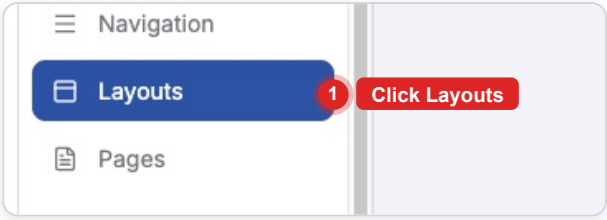
Open **Frontend > Navigation**. Click the page names you want in the menu (About, Services, Portfolio, Blog, Contact and so on), or type a custom page and click **Add**. Use the **Header menu** and **Footer menu** tabs. One page is created for every menu item, plus Home.



Frontend > Navigation

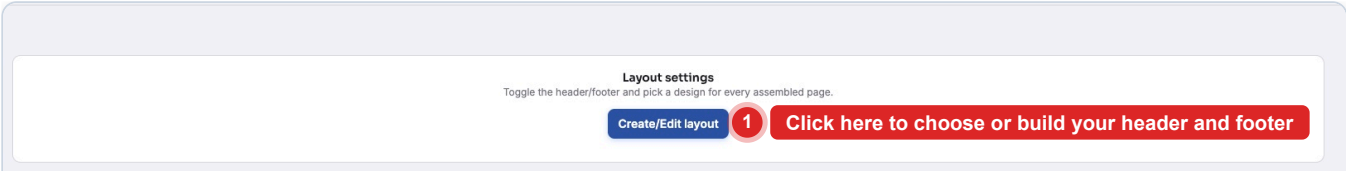
Step 10. Layouts: header and footer

Click **Layouts** in the left menu (under **Frontend**). The page shows **Layout settings**: the header and footer used on every page of your website.



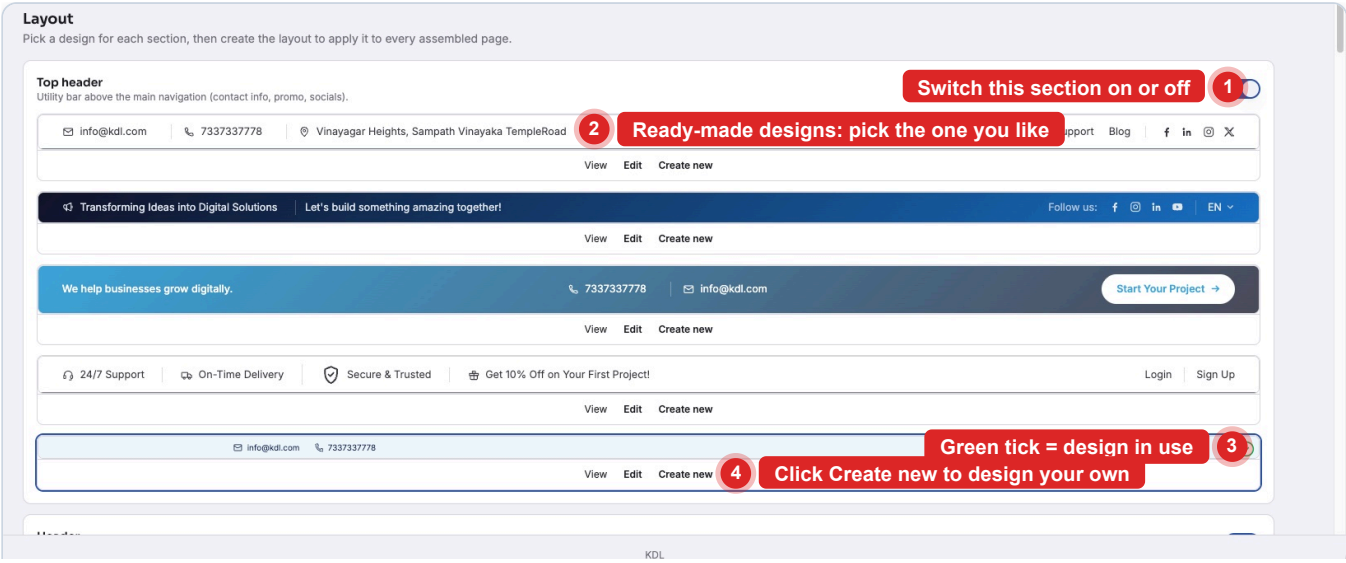
Frontend > Layouts

KDL OS already has ready-made headers and footers. You can use them as they are. If you want a fully custom one, click **Create/Edit layout**.



Layout settings

The **Layout** page lists each section (Top header, Header, Footer and more) with several designs. Use the switch on the right to turn a section on or off, and pick a design: the one with the green tick is in use. For each design you can click **View** to preview it, **Edit** to change it, or **Create new** to build your own from scratch. Then create the layout to apply it to every page. The header and footer of **Home** are shared by every public page.

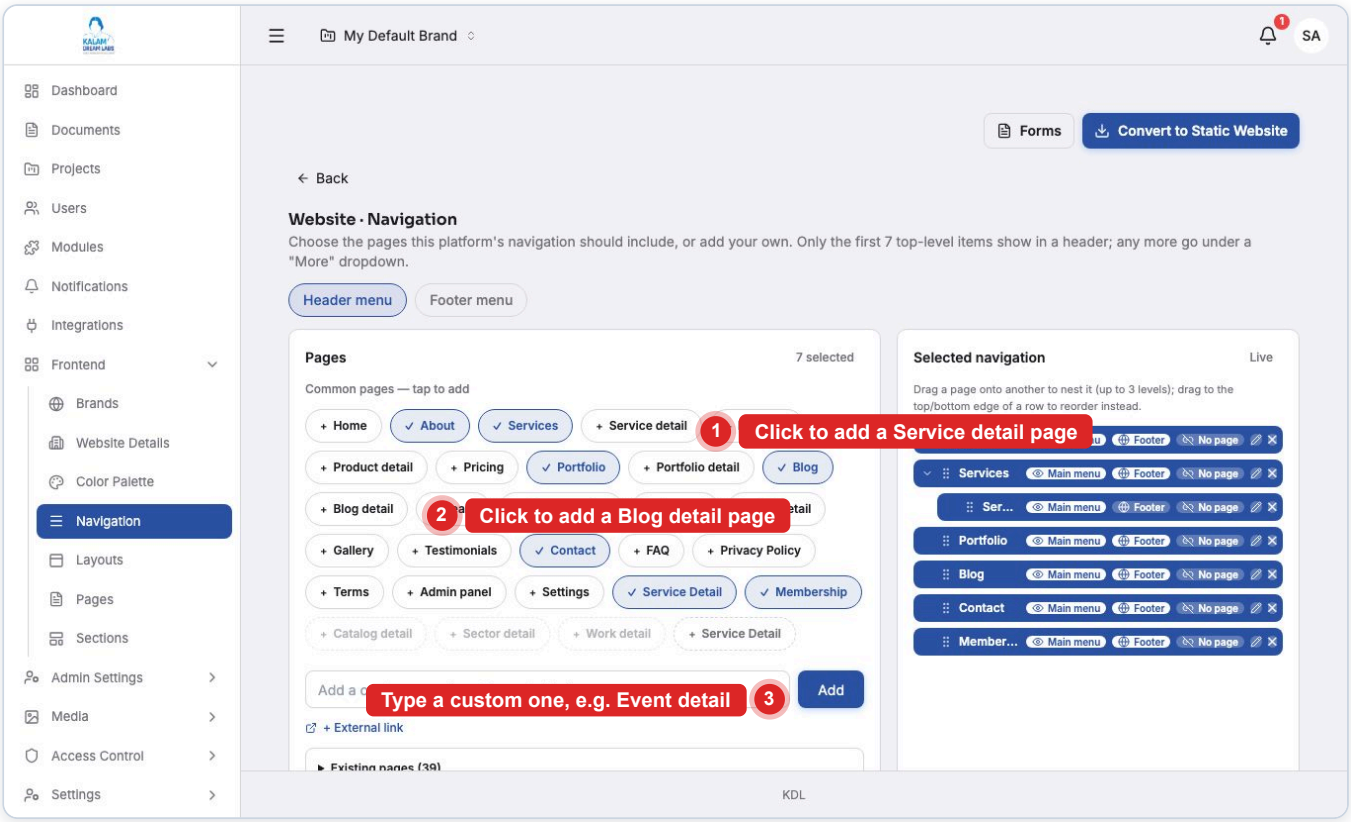


Layout: pick a design for each section

Step 11. Detail pages: one layout for every detail page

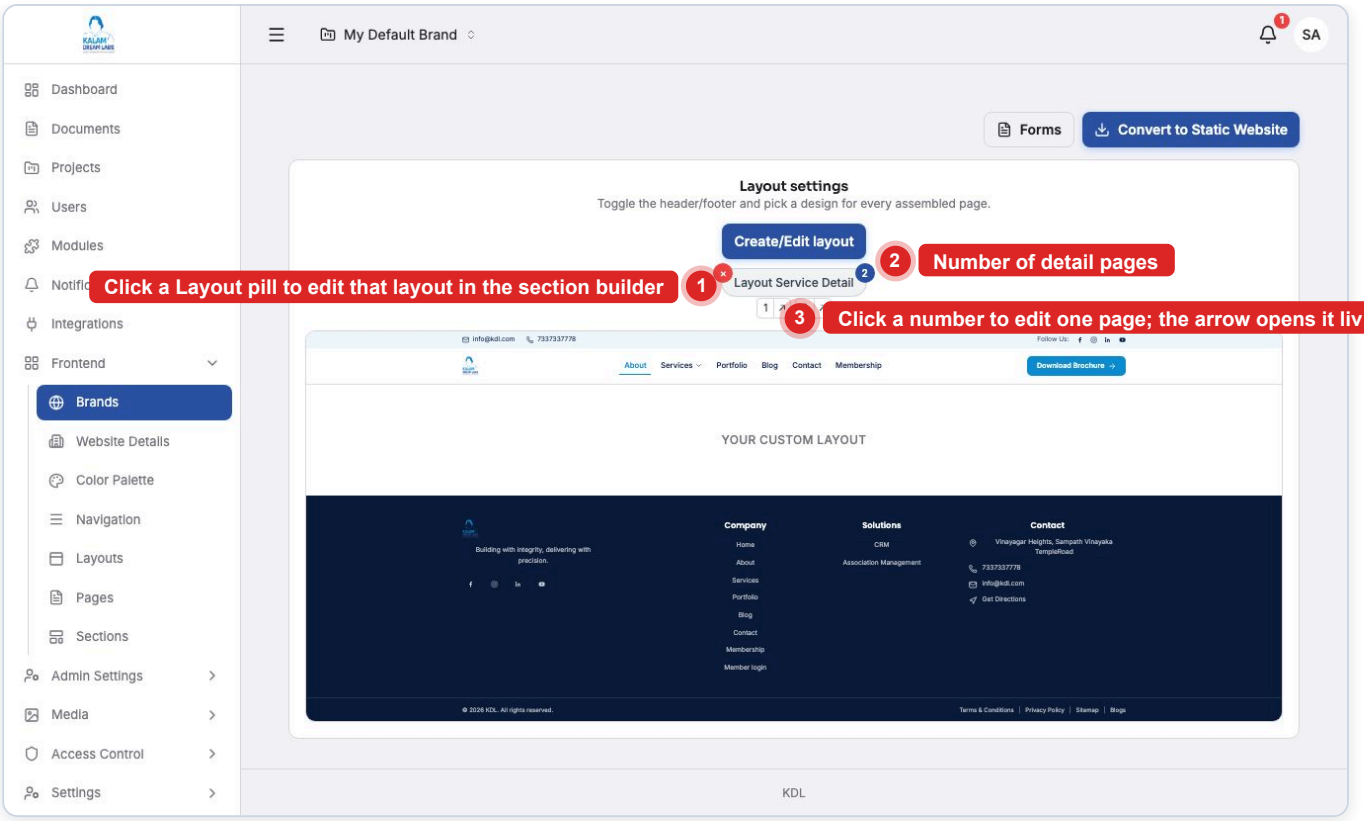
A detail page shows one item: one service, one blog post, one event, one sector. You do not build each by hand. Every item of a type shares one layout, and a page is created for each item.

A. Add the detail page types. Open **Frontend > Navigation**. Click **Service detail**, **Blog detail**, **Portfolio detail**, **Team member** or **Job detail** to add them. For another type, type a name such as **Event detail** and click **Add**. Sector, Catalog and Work detail pages appear once you add entries in those content modules.



Navigation: add the detail pages

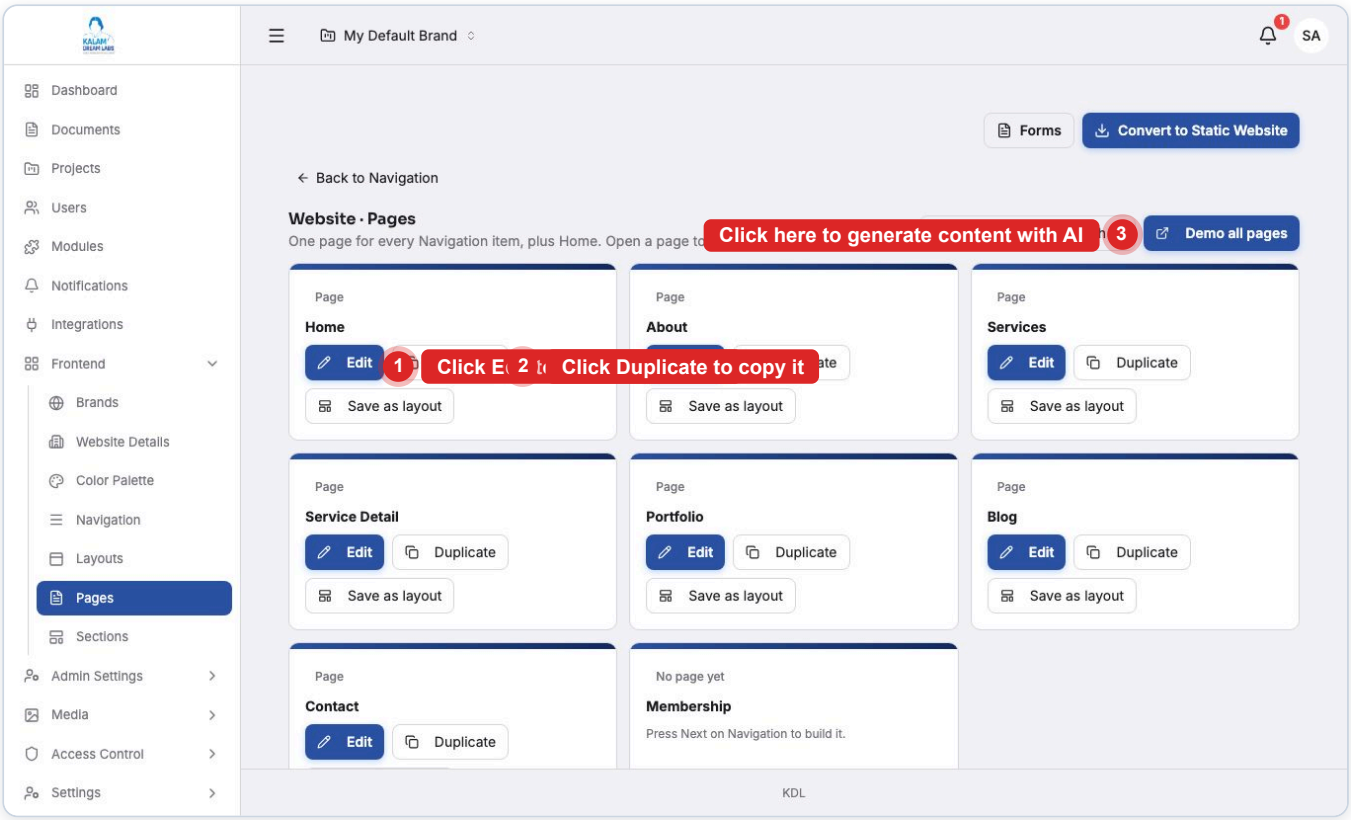
B. Edit the layout. Go back to **Layout settings** (Frontend > Brands > Web app). A pill called **Layout Service Detail** (or Layout Blog Detail, Layout Event Detail and so on) now appears for each type. Click the pill to open the section builder for that layout: change it once and every page of that type changes. The number on the pill is how many detail pages exist. Click a small number under the pill to edit one page's own content (title, text, images); the arrow opens that page live.



Layout settings: the detail page layouts

Step 12. Edit and publish the pages

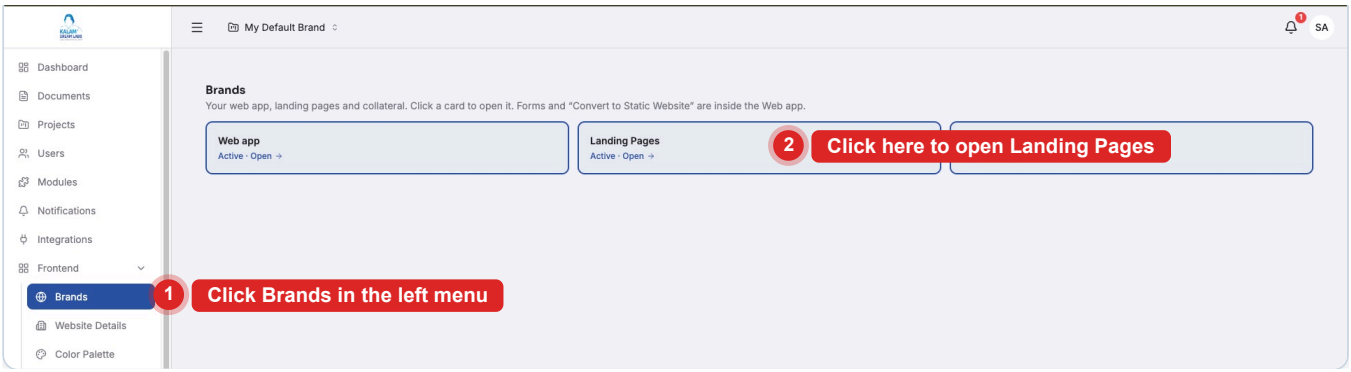
Open **Frontend > Pages**. Click **Edit** on a page to change its text, images and links in the section builder, then **Save** and **Publish**. Publish stops real problems (an empty page, a missing title, a broken link) and only suggests the rest. Click **Duplicate** to copy a page. **Frontend > Sections** holds reusable sections.



Frontend > Pages

Step 13. Click Brands and select Landing Pages

Click **Frontend > Brands** in the left menu. Three cards appear: Web app, Landing Pages and Collateral. Click the **Landing Pages** card to open it.

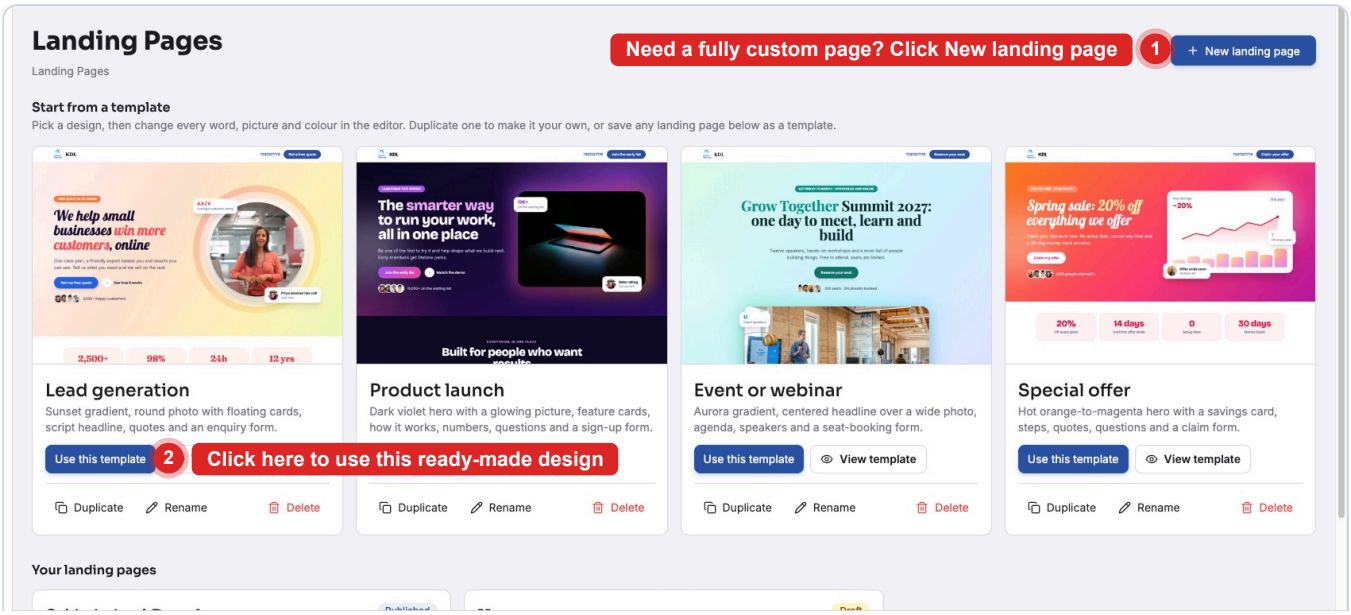


Brands: click the Landing Pages card

Step 14. Choose a landing page template

Open **Landing Pages** (http://localhost:3001/admin/landing-pages). Ready-made designs are already listed under **Start from a template**: Lead generation, Product launch, Event or webinar and Special offer. Click **View template** to preview one, then click **Use this template** to start from it. Every word, picture and colour can be changed afterwards in the editor.

If you need a fully custom page, click **New landing page** instead. This guide follows the template route.



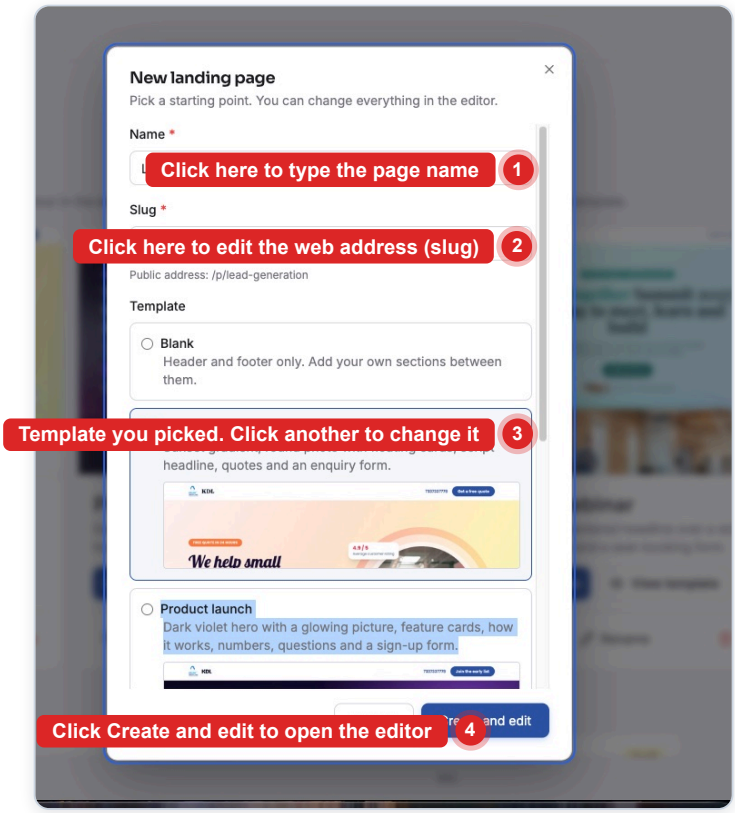
Landing Pages: start from a template

Step 15. Name the page and create it

A **New landing page** window opens with the template you picked already selected. Fill in two things, then continue:

- **Name**: the title you see in the admin, for example "Summer offer".
- **Slug**: the last part of the public web address. The page will be published at `/p/<slug>`; the full address is shown under the field.

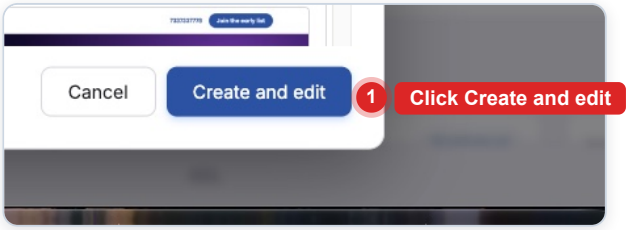
To use a different design, click another option under **Template** (choose **Blank** for a page with only a header and footer). Then click **Create and edit** to open the page in the editor.



New landing page window

Step 16. Click Create and edit, then change the page

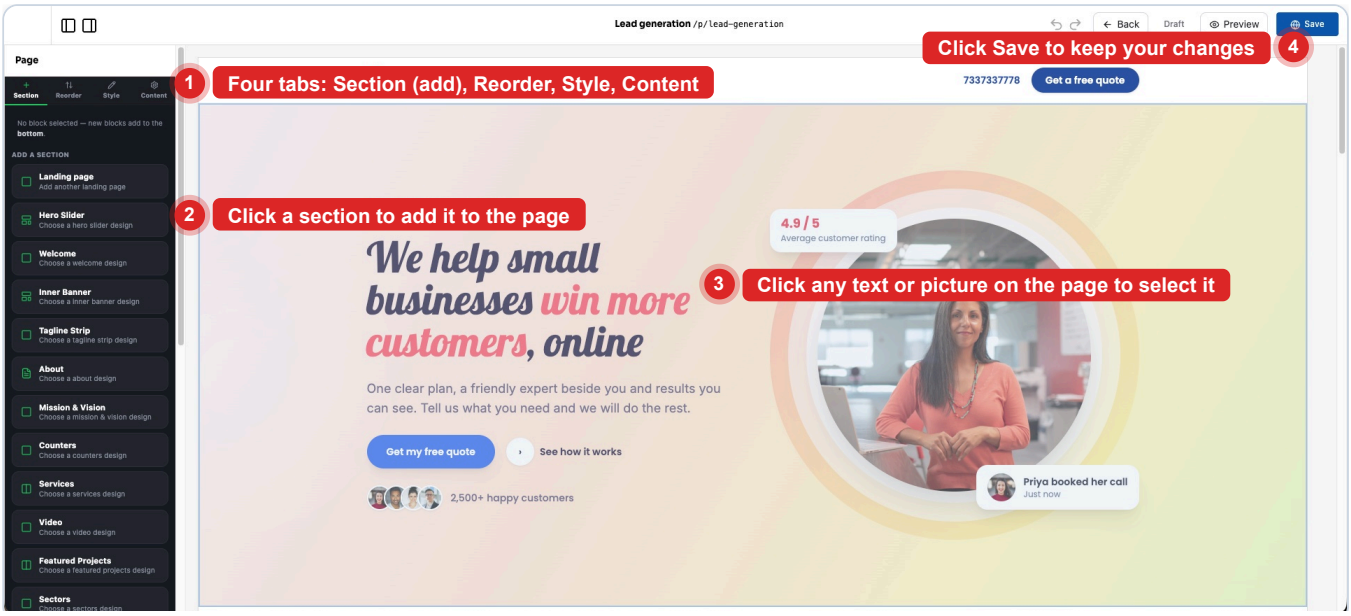
Click **Create and edit**. The page opens in the editor.



Click Create and edit

Change the page like this:

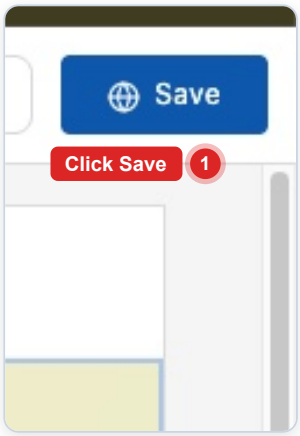
- **Content and images:** click a block on the page, then use the **Content** tab to change its text, replace its picture and edit its links (for example a button's address).
- **Look (UI):** use the **Style** tab for colours, fonts and spacing.
- **Sections:** use the **Section** tab to add sections from the list (Hero Slider, Welcome, Services and more) and the **Reorder** tab to move them. This is the section builder.
- **SEO:** the editor has no SEO button. Set the page title and description defaults in **Admin Settings > SEO**.
- Click **Preview** to see the page, then **Save**. The page stays a **Draft** until you publish it.



The landing page editor

Step 17. After editing, click Save

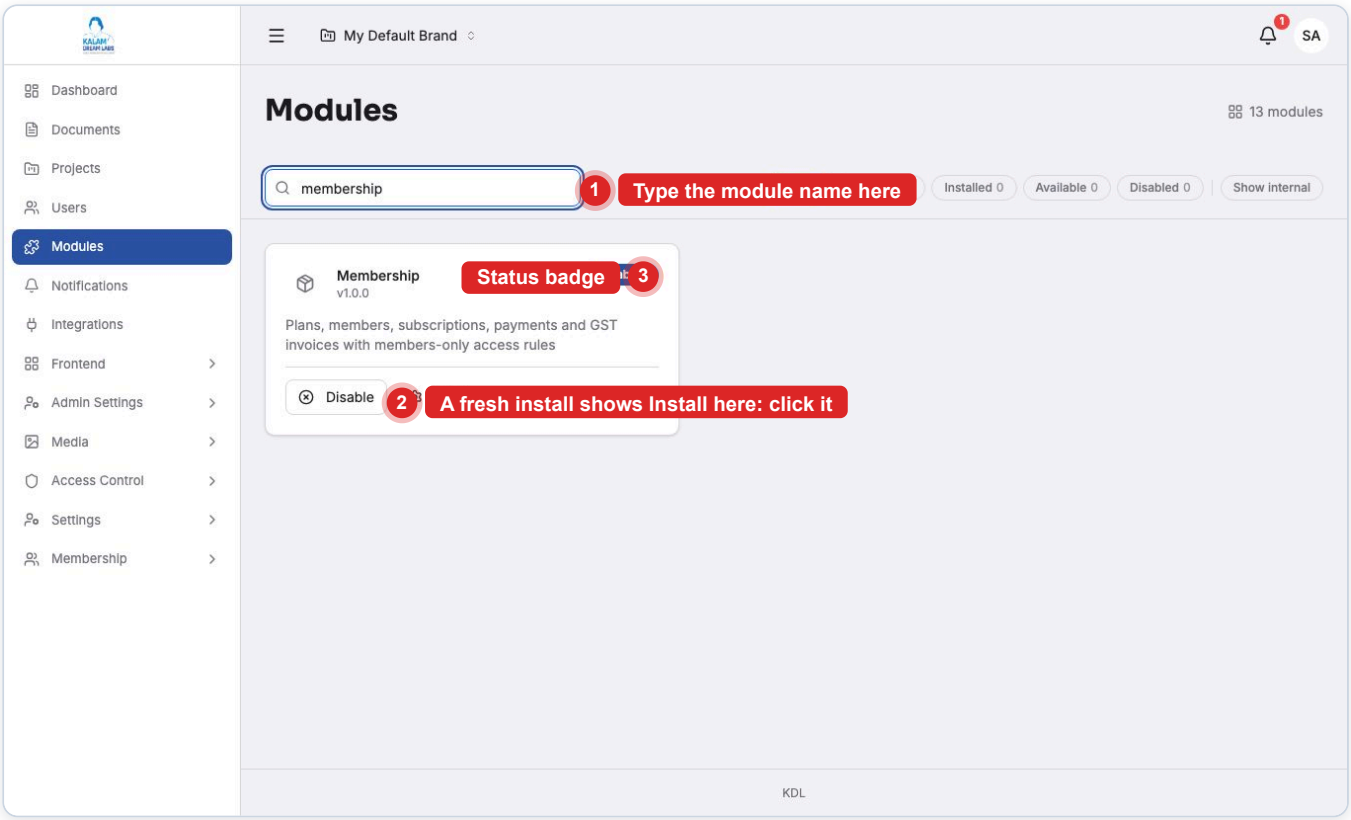
When you have finished all your changes, click **Save** at the top right of the editor. Your changes are stored and the page stays a **Draft** until you publish it. Then go back to the **Landing Pages** list (http://localhost:3001/admin/landing-pages).



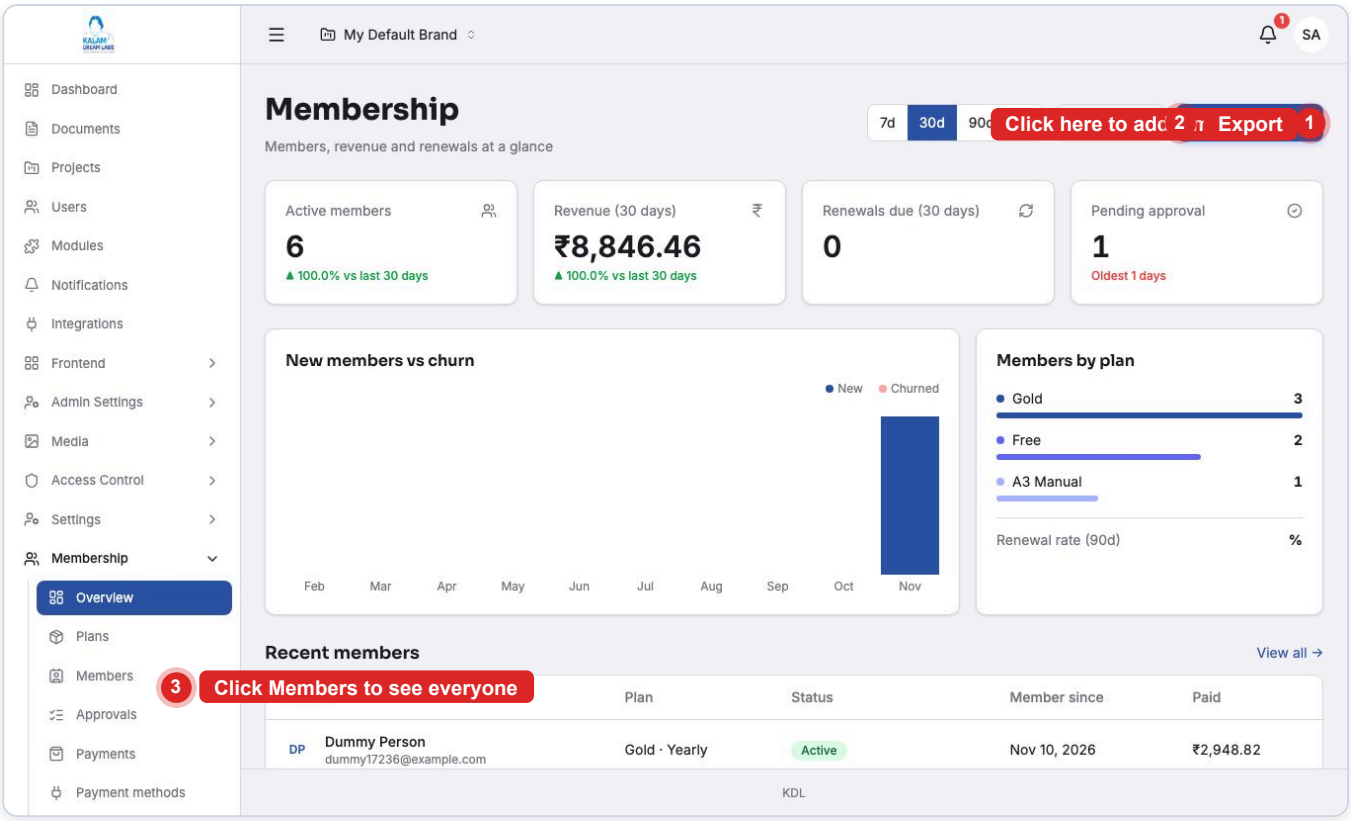
Click Save

Step 18. Turn on Membership (optional)

Open **Modules**, search **membership**, click **Install** and confirm, then **Enable** and confirm. A **Membership** group appears in the left menu with Overview, Plans, Members, Payments and Social login. Disable the module and the whole group disappears.



Search membership



Membership overview

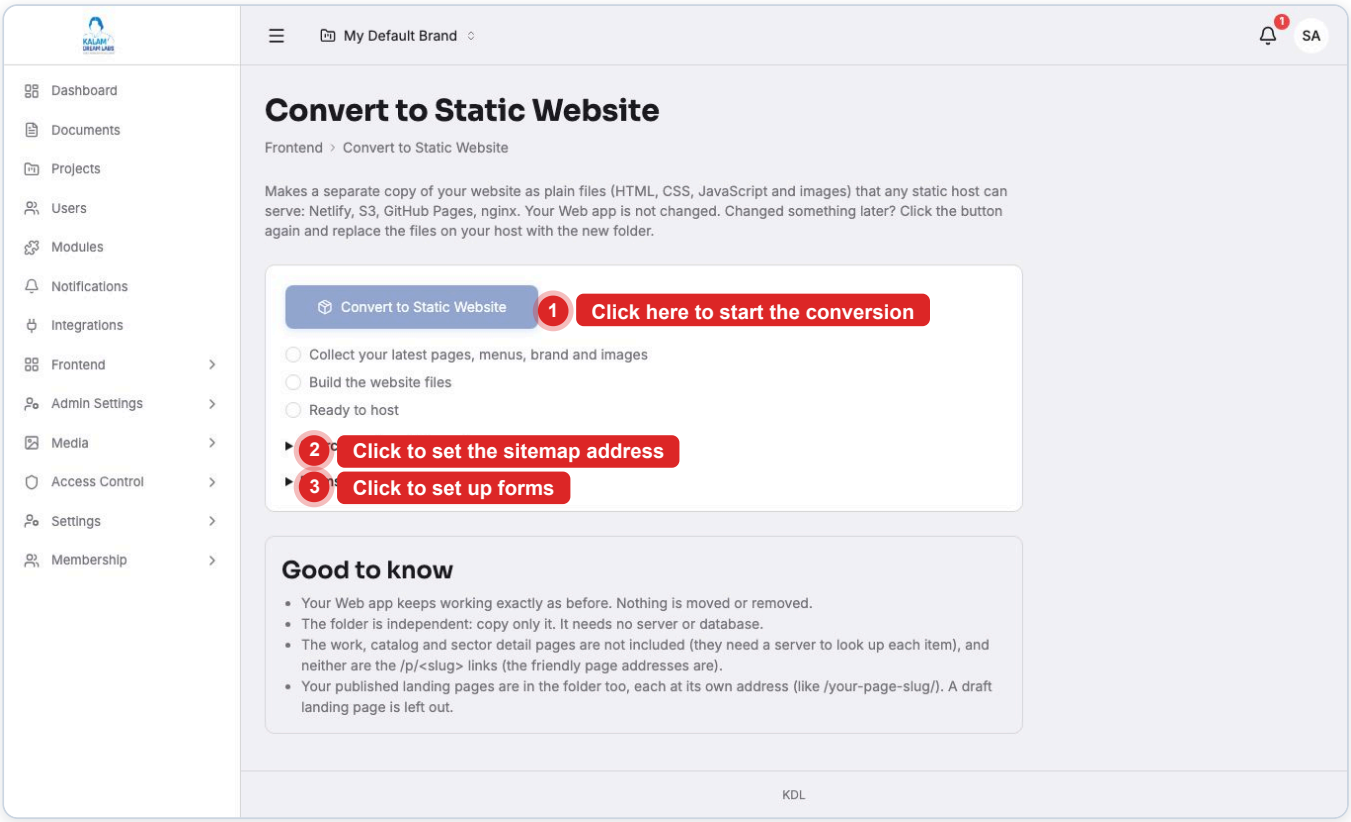
Step 19. Check the live website

Open http://localhost in a private window, signed out. Check that the header and footer match Home on every page and that every menu link opens a page. Pages are public at `/` and at `/p/<slug>`.

Step 20. Convert to a static website

Static files (HTML, CSS and images) can be hosted anywhere with no server. Publish your pages first, then click **Convert to Static Website** (the button at the top of the Studio, or http://localhost:3001/admin/static-website).

Optional: type your **Website address** (for example https://www.example.com) to add a sitemap. Type your **Web app address** (https only) if forms must keep working; if you leave it empty, forms show your contact email and phone. Click **Convert to Static Website** and wait a few minutes until the card says it is ready.



Frontend > Convert to Static Website

Step 21. Download the files and host them on GitHub

Click **Download as .zip** on the same page and unzip it. The files inside, with `index.html` at the top, are your finished website.

1. On GitHub create a new empty repository, for example `my-website`.
2. Put the files in a new folder, open a terminal in it, and run (use your own username and repository name):

```
TERMINAL
git init
git add .
git commit -m "Website"
git branch -M main
git remote add origin https://github.com/YOUR-USERNAME/my-website.git
git push -u origin main
```

3. On GitHub open **Settings > Pages**, choose **Deploy from a branch**, pick **main** and the **/ (root)** folder, then **Save**.
4. After a minute your website is live at `https://YOUR-USERNAME.github.io/my-website/`.

Notes: Changing things later

This is not a step. Use it when something changes.

- **Text, images, links:** Frontend > Pages, Edit, Save, Publish. No re-run is needed.
- **Menus:** Frontend > Navigation.
- **Header, top bar or footer:** Studio > Layouts > Create/Edit layout.
- **Colours or fonts:** Studio > Color Palette, Submit palette.
- **Change a landing page:** open http://localhost:3001/admin/landing-pages?finished=1, click **Edit**, change it in the section builder, **Save**.
- After any change: publish, then click **Convert to Static Website** again, replace the files in your GitHub folder, then `git add .`, `git commit -m "Update"` and `git push`. The static copy never updates itself.